

[NT Lesson 44](#): “God Is Love “ 1-3 John (See L44 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us understand how the Father and the Son show their love for us and how we should show our love for them. (1 John 1:1-4 is John’s testimony of the risen Christ. †1. Why study 1 John?)

1. Manifestations of Heavenly Father’s love for us.

- Read [1 John 2:28-29](#); [1 John 3:1-2](#); [1 John 4:7-19](#); and [1 John 5:1, 11-15](#).

If you were to use one word to describe Heavenly Father, what would it be?

- 1 John 4:8, 16. “He that loveth not knoweth not God; for God is love.”
 - 1 John 3:1-2. What “manner of love the Father hath bestowed upon us, that we should be called the sons of God”.
- †2. Sons of God †3. Monte Shelley

- 1 John 4:9-10. “In this was manifested the love of God toward us, because that God sent his only begotten Son”.
- 1 John 4:13. “Hereby know we that we dwell in him ... because he hath given us of his Spirit.”

How has the Spirit been an important manifestation of His love in your life?

- 1 John 5:14-15. The “confidence we have in him, ... if we ask anything according to his will, he heareth us”.
- How has prayer helped you feel Heavenly Father’s love? How can it help us become like Him?
- 1 John 4:19-21. “We love him, because he first loved us. If a man say, I love God, and hateth his brother, he is a liar”.
- †4. President Thomas S. Monson

2. Manifestations of the Savior’s love for us.

- Read [1 John 1:7-9](#); [1 John 2:1-2](#); [1 John 3:5-8, 16](#); and [1 John 5:11-13](#).

- 1 John 3:16. “Hereby perceive we the love of God, because he laid down his life for us: and we ought to ...”

What blessings can we receive because of the Savior’s atoning sacrifice?

(See [1 John 1:7-9](#); [1 John 5:11-13](#); [2 Nephi 9:11-13](#); and [Alma 11:40-44](#).)

- 1 John 2:1-2. “And if any man sin, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous. And he is the propitiation for our sins”. Propitiation, “the act of propitiating or appeasing a god, spirit, or person: *he lifted his hands in propitiation*.” Advocate, “a person who pleads on someone else’s behalf”.

What does Jesus, as our advocate, do for us? (Ponderize how Jesus pleads our cause: D&C 45:3-5.)

- 1 John 3:8. “He that committeth sin is of the devil ... For this purpose the Son of God was manifested, that he might destroy the works of the devil.”

How do the Savior’s life and teachings destroy the devil’s works?

3. Showing our love for Heavenly Father, Jesus Christ, and others

- Read [1 John 2:3-17](#); [1 John 3:9-24](#); [1 John 4:4-21](#); [1 John 5:1-10](#); [2 John](#); and [3 John](#).

- 1 John 2:3-6. “Hereby we do know that we know him, if we keep his commandments...”

How does obedience show our love for God? †5. Which Loved Best, by Joy Allison (1917)

- 2 John 1:4 and 3 John 1:4. “I rejoiced greatly that I found of thy children walking in truth”.

How can our faithfulness bring joy to our Heavenly Father?

- 1 John 2:15-17. “Love not the world, [or] things that are in the world. [If we do,] the love of the Father is not in us.”

How are we affected when we show love for the world?

How can we overcome a love for worldly things?

- 1 John 4:7-8, 11. “Let us love one another: for love is of God; and everyone that loveth is born of God”.

Why is our love for others a measure of our love of God? (See 1 John 2:9, 11; 3:14-15, 17; 4:20.)

How can we come to feel and demonstrate greater love for each other?

- 1 John 2:22-23; 1 John 4:13; and 2 John 1:7. Anti-Christ. †6. Elder M. Russell Ballard

Next Week: L45 “He That Overcometh Shall Inherit All Things”; See L45: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

Read the Institute New Testament Student Manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#). † •

NT44 Quotes

†1. **Why study 1 John?:** “The Epistle of 1 John was written at a time when apostasy was spreading in the Church. In this epistle John addressed the dangerous spread of apostate influences in the Church and gave an apostolic warning to the Saints to have no fellowship with darkness but to stay in the safety of gospel light. Although some of the false teachings that John refuted in this epistle are different from those prevalent in the world today, studying 1 John can help modern Church members become more discerning of false teachings about Jesus Christ, and following John’s counsel can help them maintain close fellowship with the Lord as they abide in the truth.” (*New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*; [Chapter 52: 1 John, 2 John, 3 John, and Jude](#). Scroll down to *Why study John?*)

†2. **Sons of God:** “While all of us are spirit children of God, the use of the words ‘sons of God’ in 1 John 3:1-2 refers to those who take upon themselves the name of Christ through baptism and honor his name through faith and righteousness.” (*LM*)

See Mosiah 5:7 “And now, because of the covenant which ye have made ye shall be called the children of Christ, his sons, and his daughters; for behold, this day he hath spiritually begotten you; for ye say your hearts are changed through faith on his name; therefore, ye are born of him and have become his sons and his daughters.” (Mosiah 5:5-9)

See also Moroni 7:48. “Wherefore, my beloved brethren, pray unto the Father with all energy of heart, that ye may be filled with this love, which he hath bestowed upon all who are true followers of his Son, Jesus Christ; that ye may become the sons of God; ...”

†3. **Monte Shelley:** “Korihor: ‘whatsoever a man did was no crime.’ (Alma 30:17) [Nehor said] all mankind should be saved at the last day, ... (Alma 1:4)

“For some, this heresy is now stated, ‘Since God loves everyone unconditionally, all will be saved.’

“God loves us unconditionally in the sense that like the father of the prodigal son, he continually invites us to come or return to him and waits for us to do so. He is easy to please, but hard to satisfy.

“**Russell M. Nelson:** While divine love can be called perfect, infinite, enduring, and universal, it cannot correctly be characterized as *unconditional*. The word does not appear in the scriptures. On the other hand, many verses affirm that the higher levels of love the Father and the Son feel for each of us—and certain divine blessings stemming from that love—are *conditional*.” (*Ensign*, Feb 2003, 20-25).

†4. **President Thomas S. Monson:** “Our Heavenly Father’s plan contains the ultimate expressions of true

love. All that we hold dear—even our families, our friends, our joy, our knowledge, our testimonies—would vanish were it not for our Father and His Son, the Lord Jesus Christ. ... The world has witnessed no greater gift, nor has it known more lasting love” (“[Gifts](#),” *Ensign*, May 1993, 62–63).

†5. **Which Loved Best, by Joy Allison (1917):**

“I love you, Mother,” said little John;
Then forgetting his work, his cap went on.
And he was off to the garden swing,
Leaving his mother the wood to bring.

“I love you, Mother,” said little Nell,
“I love you better than tongue can tell.”
Then she teased and pouted full half the day.
Till her mother was glad when she went to play.

“I love you, Mother,” said little Fan,
“To-day I’ll help you all I can;
How glad I am that school doesn’t keep!”
And she rocked the babe til he fell asleep.

Then stepping softly, she took the broom,
And swept the floor, and dusted the room.
Busy and happy all day was she;
Helping and happy as a child could be.

“I love you, Mother,” again they said,
Three little children going to bed.
How do you think that mother guessed
Which of them really loved her best?
(*Beloved LDS Poems*)

†6. **Elder M. Russell Ballard:** “Individual, personal testimony of gospel truth, particularly of the divine life and mission of the Lord Jesus Christ, is essential to our eternal life. ... Life eternal is predicated upon our own individual, personal knowledge of our Father in Heaven and His Holy Son. Simply knowing about them is not enough. We must have personal, spiritual experiences to anchor us. These come through seeking them in the same intense, single-minded way that a hungry person seeks food” (“[Feasting at the Lord’s Table](#),” *Ensign*, May 1996, 80).

Recommended Reading:

1. [NT44 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more quotes and links to articles, blogs, and talks.

2. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 52: 1 John, 2 John, 3 John, and Jude](#).

3. President Thomas S. Monson, “[Gifts](#),” *Ensign*, May 1993, 62–63.

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